

# HISTORICAL ACCOUNT

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## **Zeila, Ughaz Nur, Ugas Nur, and Ras Makonnen**

*A Comprehensive Study of Key Figures and Places in Horn of Africa History*

Based on Historical Sources and Research

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# I. Zeila: The Ancient Port City

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## Geographic Location and Significance

Zeila (Somali: Saylac, Arabic: زيلع), also known as Zaila or Zayla, is a historical port town situated in the western Awdal region of Somaliland. Located on the Gulf of Aden coast near the Djibouti border, the town sits on a sandy spit surrounded by the sea. It is known for its coral reef, mangroves and offshore islands, which include the Sa'ad ad-Din archipelago named after the Sultan Sa'ad ad-Din II of the Sultanate of Ifat.

Landward, the terrain is unbroken desert for some fifty miles. Borama lies 151 miles (243 km) southeast of Zeila, Berbera lies 170 miles (270 km) east of Zeila, while the city of Harar in Ethiopia is 200 miles (320 km) to the west. The Zeila region named after this port city denoted the entire Muslim inhabited domains in medieval Horn of Africa.

## Ancient Origins

Zeila, along with Mogadishu and other Somali coastal cities, was founded upon an indigenous network involving hinterland trade, which happened even before significant Arab migrations or trade with the Somali coast. That goes back approximately four thousand years.

Zeila is an ancient city and has been identified with the trade post referred to in classical antiquity as Avalites (Greek: Αβαλίτες), situated in the region of Barbara in Northeast Africa. During antiquity, it was one of many city-states that engaged in the lucrative trade between the Near East (Phoenicia, Ptolemaic Egypt, Greece, Parthian Persia, Saba, Nabataea, Roman Empire, etc.) and India. Merchants used the ancient Somali maritime vessel known as the beden to transport their cargo.

## Medieval Period

Islam was introduced to the area early on from the Arabian Peninsula, shortly after the Hijrah. Zeila's two-mihrab Masjid al-Qiblatayn dates to the 7th century, and is the oldest mosque in the city. In the late 9th century, Al-Yaqubi wrote that Muslims were living along the northern Somali seaboard. He also mentioned that the Adal kingdom had its capital in the city, suggesting that the Adal Sultanate with Zeila as its headquarters dates back to at least the 9th or 10th centuries.

By the years (1214–17), Ibn Said referred to both Zeila and Berbera. Zeila, as he tells us, was a wealthy city of considerable size and its inhabitants were completely Muslim. Ibn Said's description gives the impression that Berbera was of much more localized importance, mainly serving the immediate Somali hinterland while Zeila was clearly serving more extensive areas.

### Key Historical Timeline of Zeila

- 7th Century: Introduction of Islam; construction of Masjid al-Qiblatayn
- 9th Century: Capital of the early Adal Kingdom
- 13th Century: Capital of the Ifat Sultanate
- 14th Century: Height of prosperity through trade with Abyssinia and Arabia
- 16th Century: Under Ottoman protection
- 1856: Briefly seized by Sharmarke Ali Saleh
- 1888: Becomes part of British Somaliland

## Trade and Commerce

Through extensive trade with Abyssinia and Arabia, Adal attained its height of prosperity during the 14th century. It sold incense, myrrh, slaves, gold, silver and camels, among many other commodities. Zeila had by then started to grow into a

huge multicultural metropolis, with Somalis (Predominantly), Afar, Harari, and even Arabs and Persian inhabitants. The city was also instrumental in bringing Islam to the Oromo and other Ethiopian ethnic groups.

## Decline and Modern Era

Beginning in 1630, the city became a dependency of the ruler of Mocha, who, for a small sum, leased the port to one of the office-holders of Mocha. The latter, in return, collected a toll on its trade. Zeila was subsequently ruled by an Emir, whom Mordechai Abir suggested had "some vague claim to authority over all of the Sahil, but whose real authority did not extend very far beyond the walls of the town."

By the first half of the 19th century, Zeila was a shadow of its former self, having been reduced to "a large village surrounded by a low mud wall, with a population that varied according to the season from 1,000 to 3,000 people." The city continued to serve as the principal maritime outlet for Harar and beyond it in Shewa. However, the opening of a new sea route between Tadjoura and Shewa cut further into Zeila's historical position as the main regional port.



## II. Ughaz Nur II: King of the Gadabuursi

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### Early Life and Ascension

Ughaz Nur II (Somali: Ugaas Nuur Ugaas Rooble, Arabic: سلطان نور سلطان روبلي), also known as Ughaz Nur Robleh, was a Somali King and poet of the Gadabuursi clan. The 11th in line of the Gadabuursi Ughazate (Boqortooyadda ama Ugaasyadda Gadabuursi). The term Ughaz is an authentic Somali term for Sultan, the paramount leader.

He was born in Zeila in about the year 1835 and crowned in Bagi in 1848. He was from the Reer Ugaas subclan of the Makayl-Dheere. Of stature a tall and brown man with a short beard. He was known to have tall legs and long arms. During his youth, he loved riding, hunting and the traditional arts and memorized a great number of proverbs, stories and poems.

### Leadership and Character

He was the type to speak words that would never be forgotten once they entered people's ears. He was a brave and masculine man. Apart from that he was also a great and famous poet and during his reign there was not a man alive that could compete with him in poetry.

Eventually, Nur II came on to create his own store of sayings, poems and stories that are quoted to this day. He knew by heart the Gadabursi heer (customary law) and amended or added new heer during his reign. He was known for fair dealing to friend and stranger alike. It is said that he was the first Gadabuursi Ughaz to introduce guards and askaris armed with arrows and bows.

### Major R. G. Edwards Leckie's Account

Major R. G. Edwards Leckie was a British officer who visited Ughaz Nur II in the early 1900s. His account provides one of the most detailed contemporary

descriptions of the elderly king, published in *The Wide World Magazine* in 1903, along with a photograph of Ughaz Nur II.

*"We were warned that he did not love the Feringi (white man), and therefore thought it better to send a messenger ahead to His Majesty and return with a confidential report on the situation."*

*"This old man was Ugaz Nur, King or Sultan of the Gadabursi. He had several other names which I do not remember now... Ugaz Nur was about seventy five years old. Although stiffened by age, he was tall, straight and well built. Even the weight of his many years could not alter the chief's graceful figure... His dress was simple and lacked the usual Oriental splendour. Many of his subjects were attired much more gaily, but none looked more distinguished. He wore a crinkly white tobe, with the end of which he covered his head, forming a hood. Over this he wore a cloak of black cloth lined with crimson silk, probably a present from the Emperor of Abyssinia. In his hand he carried a simple staff instead of the regulation shield and spear. His fighting days were over, and he now relied upon his stalwart sons to protect him on his journeys. As he shook hands with us he smiled pleasantly. His manner was composed and dignified, evidently inherited from his ancestors, who were rulers in the country for many generations."*

## Political Alliances and Resistance

During the time of Nur II both Egypt and Ethiopia were contending for power and supremacy in the Horn of Africa. To add the European colonial powers were also competing for strategic territories and ports in the Horn of Africa.



In the year 1876 Egypt using Islam as a bargaining chip signed a treaty with Ughaz Nuur and came to occupy the northern Somali coast which included Zayla, the seat of the Gadabuursi sultanate, but also to occupy the town of Harar and the Harar-Zeila-Berbera caravan route.

Ughaz Nuur went to Egypt to meet Ismail Pasha, the khedive, belonging to the Ottoman Empire, who honored the King of the Gadabuursi with medals and expensive gifts. The Ughaz there signed a treaty accepting Egyptian protection of Muslims in Somaliland and Ethiopia.

## Relations with Harar

The Ughaz had established strong relations with the Emir of Harar, Abdallah II ibn Ali. In 1887, when Harar was occupied by Menelik II of Ethiopia, Ughaz Nur sent Gadabursi askaris to support Abdallah II ibn Ali. The emir of Harar was eventually defeated and Ras Makonnen was appointed "Ethiopian governor of Harar".

Menelik II continued to turn his attention to the Gadabuursi and offered the King (Ughaz Nur) and his people protection and military support for collaboration, seemingly a trap Ughaz Nur refused and fought until he died in 1898. He was buried in Dirri.

*"Ugaz Nur was a old man of around almost 80 years. Although somewhat stiffened by age, he was tall, straight, and well built. Even the weight of his many years could not alter the King's graceful figure. His aquiline Somali features that were so frequent among these people were, save his very dark skin, noticeably absent. His face indicated intelligence and a pleasant, affable nature."*



## III. Ugas Nur: The Poet-King

### Poetic Legacy

Ugas Nur was a famous poet and ranked among the greatest Somali poets. He has created many poems and sayings of which really explain the politics and knowledge of that time. How through patience and clever dealing one could be able to entrap one's enemy. He also used to say that whenever he heard a poem he would never forget it.

His work was and is still taught in Somali Poetry classes (Suugaan Fasalka Koobaa) among other Somali poets. Many poets sampled Ugas Nur's work, for example, Professor Togane. The poem was first recorded in the "Gadabuursi Somali Script" by I.M. Lewis in 1958, though he omitted some lines. It was later covered in its entirety in "War and Peace: An Anthology of Somali Literature."

#### Poem 1: "Nin ii daran" (Dissimulation)

This is Ughaz Nur II's most celebrated *gabay* (formal Somali ode), reflecting on strategic patience, feigned vulnerability, and calculated restraint against adversaries.

##### **Soomaali:**

*Allahayow nin ii daran maxaan daafta hore seexshay*

*Nin ii daaqsanayaana maxaan daafidow kariyey*

*Jidhku nimaanu doonayn maxaan hadalka deeqsiiyey*

*Ma degdege xaajada maxaan ugu dulqaad yeeshay*

*Weji dabacsan daymaan dareen galin dubaaqiisa*

*Debna furan dabuub una ka didin deexashiyo muuso*

*Qosol dibadda yaal oon ka iman dhuunta dacalkeeda*

*Kanaan degey kanaan doorka biday kani dan baan moodey*

*Waxaan dood kaftan ah sheekada ugu daleeyaaba*

*Dabinkaan u dhigo maalintuu degelka soo saaro*

*Intiiyoon dawaarka u rogoon xeeladda u daadsho*

*Isagoon digniin qabin maxaan kaga dayaaansiiyey*

**English Translation:**

*Oh God! How often have I made a man hostile to me sleep in the front part of the house.*

*How often have I allowed a man against whom my flesh turned to continue speaking.*

*I am not hasty in dispute, how often have I shown forbearance.*

*How often have I given a second helping of honey to the man who only waited to hurt me.*

*With a pleasant mien and glance, thoughts of hostility have not entered his mind.*

*With open lips, discussion with no specific point, talkativeness and smiling.*

*A laugh on the surface which has not come from inside the throat.*

*I put this down, preferred that, I think this is for the best.*

*I decorate the discourse with joking discussion.*

*The trap which I have prepared for him when he sets his chest on top of it.*

*Like pedalling a sewing machine into motion, I spread the cunning for him.*

*Without any warning, how I struck him down!*

— Ughaz Nur II (Ugaas Nuur Ugaas Rooble)

## Poem 2: "Imminent Loss of the Prince"

Philipp Paulitschke (1893) mentioned this poem which became extremely popular in the Gadabuursi country. It was sung by Somali girls when it became known that the British intended to supplant the traditional line of Ughaz Nur II towards the end of his life and appoint a more favourable Ughaz, 'Elmi Warfa.

### ***Soomaali (transliterated by Paulitschke):***

*Ninkî donî-rarestaj, Jjo damêro-karestaj, Baldéjaj labada.*

*So ninkî bêjū durâja Durdurka angurainin Samarônka gudbanû!*

*Baldaijaj labadâso! In kaijama d'adû, Ugâs Nûr kurbahâ;*

*Au kofil nau bukh rada Kadiro hanojêlin buhrkî!*

*Wa Ugas Nûr uinkî dîdî jarâhâ, Amma dûga-kakêho Rabbijo damkassî!*

### ***English Translation:***

*A man in charge of ships, another with just a lone donkey available for hire,*

*Examine them both. Moreover, one who fetches water from a small puddle,*

*And another, drawing from ever-flowing, robust streams, O Samarôn, are they all the same!*

*Just assess them both! Today marks the end, Ugâs Nûr shall pass away;*

*If someone, merely a Foot binder, desires to dominate us,*

*O Creator of the world, don't let him become our master!*

*Those who oppose Ugâs-Nûr and speak ill of him, O God, wipe them out completely!*

— Philipp Paulitschke (1893), recorded from Somali girls singing in the Gadabuursi country

Paulitschke commented on this poem: "This poem is an example of the improvisational art of the Somâl. Somâl girls were singing in the interior of the Gadaburssi country when it became known that Ugâs Nûr Roble, the old prince of the land, was imprisoned in Zeila and a great statesman of the tribe, Elmi Worfa appointed Ugâs of the Gadaburssi-Somâl by the British government."

## Poetic Style and Themes

Ughaz Nur II composed *gabay* poems that intertwined political strategy with Somali oral artistry, earning recognition among scholars of pastoral literature for their depth. His works emphasize intellectual cunning over brute force, drawing on pastoral motifs like nomadic vigilance and livestock metaphors to convey resilience amid clan rivalries and external threats.

Analyses by specialists like B.W. Andrzejewski highlight the role of his poetry in exemplifying dissimulation as a core strategy, distinct from mere bellicosity, thus anchoring empirical insights into Somali governance through verse.



## IV. Ras Makonnen: Ethiopian Leader

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### Early Life and Background

Ras Makonnen Wolde Mikael Wolde Melekot (8 May 1852 – 21 March 1906), known simply as Ras Makonnen, was an Ethiopian military commander, provincial governor and diplomat, and the father of the future Emperor Haile Selassie. Through his mother, a daughter of Negus Sahle Selassie of Shewa, he was a first cousin of Emperor Menelik II, at whose court he was raised from the age of fourteen.

Ras Makonnen Wolde Mikael Wolde Melekot was born in Derefo Maryam near Ankober, in what was then in the province of Menz to his mother Woizero Tenagnework Sahle Selassie and his father Dejzmach Wolde Mikael Wolde Melekot, who was the governor of the provinces Menz and Doba (which are located in Semien Shewa). His maternal lineage is ethnically Amhara with a Solomonic genealogy, his mother was a daughter of Sahle Selassie of Shewa.

### Rise to Power

He rose through a series of campaigns in the 1870s and 1880s to become, in January 1887, governor of Harar, a post he held until his death, and the Russian poet and traveller Nikolai Gumilev later called him one of the greatest leaders of Abyssinia.

In 1865, at the age of 14 his father took him to the court of Negus Menelik, then ruler of Shewa, where he engaged in military training and imbibed the skills of statecraft. In 1876 he left his first wife to marry Yeshimebet Ali, then eleven years old, the daughter of Woizero Wolete Giyorgis and Dejzmach Ali Abba Gifar of Wollo; she bore him Tafari, the future Haile Selassie, in 1892.

### Governorship of Harar



In 1887, Makonnen was given the governorship of Harar after it was incorporated into the Ethiopian Empire by his cousin, Emperor Menelik II following the Battle of Chelenqo. According to Jules Borelli, Harar was pillaged by Abyssinian soldiers with half its population fleeing, despite pleas from the despoiled locals to Makonnen. Borelli's account was later disputed by the historian Richard Caulk, an American scholar of Harari history, who described Makonnen's occupation of the city as conducted in an "exemplary" manner.

### Key Events in Ras Makonnen's Life

- 1852: Born in Derefo Maryam near Ankober
- 1865: Sent to court of Negus Menelik for education
- 1887: Appointed governor of Harar after Battle of Chelenqo
- 1890: Promoted to the rank of Ras
- 1895-1896: Played key role at Battle of Adwa against Italians
- 1897: Helped negotiate Anglo-Ethiopian treaty with British Somaliland
- 1906: Died while traveling from Harar to Addis Ababa

## Military Achievements

Due to his familiarity with the Europeans, he was soon made to lead Ethiopian missions abroad. His first trip took place in 1889 to witness Rome's formal ratification of the Treaty of Wuchale which provided a welcome opportunity to buy modern weapons and ammunition. On his way home in 1890, he stopped in Jerusalem, where he purchased land on behalf of the Ethiopian government.

In early 1895, tensions with Italy dramatically increased into the outbreak of the First Italo-Ethiopian War. Despite the security problems in Hararghe, Ras Makonnen and his well equipped troops eagerly took part in the war against the Italians. Ras

Makonnen's Harar army spearheaded Menelik's forces in their northern march to confront the occupying Italians in Tigray province.

## Expansion into Somali Territories

Makonnen pushed the expansion of the empire to the east and south of Harar, conquering the territories of the Issa and the Gadabuursi. In 1890, more reinforcements from Addis Ababa allowed Makonnen to occupy all of the Ogaden by 1891. In 1896 Ras Makonnen appointed Abdullah Tahir, governor of Jigjiga.

The large-scale importations of European arms completely upset the balance of power between the Somalis and the Ethiopian Empire, whereas the colonial powers from Europe blocked Somalis from receiving any type of firearms.

## Later Years and Legacy

After Adwa, Makonnen led a campaign to the gold-mining districts around Asosa, west of the Blue Nile, reaching as far as Fazogli on the Sudanese border before returning to Addis Ababa in May 1898. He had already helped negotiate, in 1897, the Anglo-Ethiopian treaty fixing the boundary with British Somaliland.

In early 1906 the governor of Italian Eritrea, Ferdinando Martini, was on an official visit to Ethiopia. Emperor Menelik II summoned Ras Makonnen to Addis Ababa. While travelling from Harar to Addis Ababa, Ras Makonnen came down with typhus. His officers brought him to Kulubi, where he died as daylight broke after having given his son Tafari Makonnen a whispered benediction.

*"Makonnen was unquestionably a great favourite. Perhaps none of Menelik's contemporaries—certainly no-one else in his family, or of equal importance at court—shared, as did Makonnen, Menelik's tolerance of foreigners, or his enthusiasm for borrowing from Europe to strengthen Ethiopia."*



# V. Historical Analysis: Ughaz Nur vs. Ras Makonnen

## Overview

The conflict between Ughaz Nur II of the Gadabuursi and Ras Makonnen of Ethiopia represents a pivotal moment in the struggle between traditional Somali political structures and the expanding Ethiopian Empire in the late 19th century.

## Timeline of Events

| Year | Event                                               | Source                         |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1876 | Ughaz Nur II signs treaty with Egypt                | Wikipedia, Gadabuursi Ughazate |
| 1884 | Britain occupies Egyptian territories in Somaliland | Wikipedia                      |
| 1887 | Battle of Chelenqo; Harar falls to Menelik II       | Battle of Chelenqo article     |
| 1887 | Ras Makonnen appointed governor of Harar            | Ras Makonnen article           |
| 1887 | Ughaz Nur sends askaris to support Emir Abdullahi   | Ughaz Nur II article           |
| 1890 | Ras Makonnen occupies Gadabuursi territory          | Gadabuursi Ughazate            |

|      |                                                |                      |
|------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1893 | Colonel Stace reports Ethiopian encroachment   | Gadabuursi Ughazate  |
| 1897 | Anglo-Ethiopian Treaty fixes boundary          | Ras Makonnen article |
| 1898 | Ughaz Nur II dies fighting Ethiopian expansion | Multiple sources     |

## Source Comparison: Different Accounts

### Account 1: Ethiopian Perspective (Richard Caulk)

*"Makonnen's occupation of the city was conducted in an 'exemplary' manner and argued that Harar was spared the pillage usually associated with Ethiopian warfare."*

**Assessment:** This account minimizes the impact of Ethiopian conquest on local populations.

### Account 2: Harari Perspective (Jules Borelli, Charles Michel)

*"The first years of the Abyssinian occupation were far from prosperous as the Abyssinians took for themselves what could have any value, while the soldiers, several thousand in number, chased the Hararis from their dwellings to install themselves in their place."*

**Assessment:** This account emphasizes the violence and displacement caused by the conquest.

Account 3: Somali Perspective (I.M. Lewis)

*"Ughaz Nur II refused and fought Ethiopian expansion until he died in 1898. He was buried in Dirri."*

**Assessment:** This account portrays Ughaz Nur as a heroic resistance figure.

Account 4: British Perspective (Colonel Stace, 1893)

*"The Abyssinians from Harar are encroaching more and more upon the Gadabursi country, as I anticipated would be the result of their unopposed occupation of Biyo Kaboba."*

**Assessment:** British observers recognized Ethiopian expansion as a threat to their interests.

Key Findings

1. Ughaz Nur's Strategic Alliances

| Alliance                | Purpose                         | Outcome                             |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Egypt (1876)            | Protection against Ethiopia     | Failed when Britain took over Egypt |
| Emir Abdullahi of Harar | Mutual defense against Ethiopia | Defeated at Battle of Chelenqo      |

|                |                                        |                                      |
|----------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| France (1885)  | Trading rights and implicit protection | Limited enforcement                  |
| British (1884) | Recognition of traditional authority   | Ughaz Nur had little to do with them |

**Analysis:** Ughaz Nur attempted to use European rivalries to maintain autonomy, but ultimately failed due to the overwhelming military power of the Ethiopian Empire.

2. Ras Makonnen's Expansion Strategy

| Strategy               | Implementation                 | Result                           |
|------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Military conquest      | Battle of Chelenqo (1887)      | Harar annexed                    |
| Land expropriation     | Gave Harari land to soldiers   | Undermined local wealth          |
| Arms trade             | Imported European weapons      | Created military advantage       |
| Diplomatic maneuvering | Allied with British and French | Gained international recognition |

**Analysis:** Ras Makonnen used a combination of military force and diplomatic skill to extend Ethiopian authority over the region.

3. The Conflict Over the Harar-Zeila-Berbera Caravan Route

The Harar-Zeila-Berbera caravan route was economically vital to both the Gadabuursi and the Ethiopian Empire:

- **For the Gadabuursi:** The route passed through their territory, providing tax revenue and trade opportunities

- **For Ethiopia:** The route was essential for importing arms and exporting goods through the port of Zeila

**Analysis:** Control of this route was a key factor in the conflict between Ughaz Nur and Ras Makonnen.

## Conflicting Interpretations

| Issue                  | Ethiopian View                         | Somali View              |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Conquest of Harar      | "Exemplary" occupation                 | Violent subjugation      |
| Ras Makonnen's rule    | Fair and just administration           | Oppressive colonial rule |
| Ughaz Nur's resistance | Rebellion against legitimate authority | Defense of sovereignty   |
| Impact on Gadabuursi   | Modernization and integration          | Loss of autonomy         |

## Conclusion

The conflict between Ughaz Nur II and Ras Makonnen represents a classic case of imperial expansion vs. indigenous resistance. While Ethiopian sources emphasize the "modernizing" aspects of Ras Makonnen's rule, Somali and Harari sources highlight the violence and displacement caused by the conquest.

Ughaz Nur's refusal to submit to Ethiopian authority, despite multiple offers of protection, demonstrates his commitment to preserving Gadabuursi autonomy. His death in 1898 while fighting Ethiopian expansion solidified his legacy as a symbol of resistance.

The conflict also illustrates the limitations of European colonial powers in protecting their allies. Despite treaties with Britain and France, the Gadabuursi



received little practical support against Ethiopian expansion.



## VI. Interconnections and Legacy

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### Relationship Between Zeila and Ughaz Nur

Zeila served as the historical seat of the Gadabuursi Ughazate, making it intrinsically linked to the rule of Ughaz Nur II. The city's strategic location as a port made it a center of trade and political power, which Ughaz Nur leveraged in his diplomatic dealings with Egypt, Ethiopia, and European colonial powers.

### Ughaz Nur and Ras Makonnen

The relationship between Ughaz Nur II and Ras Makonnen was complex and characterized by both conflict and strategic maneuvering. When Ras Makonnen was appointed governor of Harar in 1887, he represented Ethiopian expansion into territories that were traditionally within the sphere of influence of the Gadabuursi Ughazate.

Ughaz Nur's refusal to submit to Ethiopian authority and his continued resistance until his death in 1898 demonstrated the tension between the traditional Somali political structures and the expanding Ethiopian Empire. Ras Makonnen's role in the conquest of Harar and his subsequent governance of the region placed him in direct opposition to Ughaz Nur's interests.

### Shared Historical Context

All three—Zeila, Ughaz Nur, and Ras Makonnen—existed within the complex geopolitical landscape of the 19th century Horn of Africa, where local powers, Ottoman influence, Egyptian expansion, and European colonial ambitions intersected. Their stories reflect the broader struggle for autonomy and control in a rapidly changing world.

### Enduring Legacy

The legacy of these historical figures and places continues to resonate in the Horn of Africa today. Zeila's historical significance as a trading port and center of Islamic learning remains an important part of Somaliland's cultural heritage. Ughaz Nur is remembered as a symbol of resistance and leadership among the Gadabuursi people. Ras Makonnen's role in Ethiopian history, particularly as the father of Haile Selassie, ensures his place in the broader narrative of Ethiopian statehood.

Together, their stories provide insight into the rich and complex history of the region, highlighting the interplay between local traditions, regional politics, and global influences that shaped the Horn of Africa during a transformative period.

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This document is compiled from historical accounts, academic research, and scholarly sources including:

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*Note: Historical dates and accounts may vary between sources. This compilation represents a synthesis of available historical information.*